

Is your financial past keeping you stuck?

Sometimes – perhaps even often – there is an element of trauma, or at least pain, to our financial past that keeps us stuck in certain behaviours that affect our relationship with money. For most of us, this starts with the environment we grew up in – whether there was enough money, whether money was spoken about, whether it was used to buy our affection or compensate for missed time, whether our parents passed on any degree of financial education whatsoever. For most of us, by the time we start earning and managing our own money, we have some sort of relationship with it already, whether we were aware of it or not. This, then, has an opportunity to compound throughout our young adulthood, as we shuffle ourselves into categories – ‘I’m a real over spender’ or ‘Oh, everyone hates me down the pub, I’m really tight’.

It might help, in understanding your current financial situation and relationship with money, to think about some of those early experiences with it and try to slot them into place. A feeling that money is scarcer or more abundant than it actually is, and what we define as a lot or a little money probably dates back to our childhood, and if we can start to unpick those attitudes and perceptions, we often spark life-changing revelations. We might also remember certain events that taught us to perceive money in a certain way, or to attach a certain feeling to it – for example, I very clearly remember, when our household finances were in disarray during my teenage years,